
Experience Sharing Session on Social Mobilization for Reconstruction

NRA Conference Hall, 23 June 2017

Participants: MoUD CL-PIU, NRA, NJST, NYF, UMN, Rotary Club, IOM, JICA, NOMAD, Mercy Corps, Lumanti, USAID, ARC, Habitat Nepal, Save the Children, World Vision, CRS, EWDE-DKH, HRRP, MinErgy, NSET, Miyamoto, ASF-Nepal, MEDAIR, Indian Embassy, EOI

Mr. Prakash Thapa, Joint Secretary, NRA chaired the session, Dr. Narayan Marasini, National Technical Coordinator welcomed the participants and introduced the agenda of the meeting highlighting the importance of social mobilization part in the reconstruction process.

Gynaeshwar Mahato, Senior Technical Advisor, SABAL [presented](#) the SABAL program implemented in six districts in the central and eastern region with an addition of five earthquake-affected districts, a USAID funded project.

- SABAL activities primarily focus on health, food security, nutrition, agriculture, disaster risk reduction and livelihoods. However, in terms of recovery and reconstruction SABAL is focusing in Sindhupalchok and Kavrepalanchok only.
- SABAL facilitators and mobile team are primarily responsible to raise awareness in earthquake and safer building construction. They also support in registration and enrollment processes of the earthquake beneficiaries.
- SABAL is focusing on long term training of 3 months (1.5 months in-house and 1.5 on the job training) rather than short term. In addition, SABAL supports the communities in rehabilitation of irrigation channels, local trails, drinking water pipelines through Cash for Work activities.
- SABAL as part of reconstruction activities has trained 1160 through 7 days' masons training, 1131 through 52 days' mason training and has covered 43,010 HHs through awareness program on earthquake resilience and safer building construction.
- SABAL also supports Government structure, mechanism, directly work with communities in building capacity. Monsoon, lack of water in the higher mountainous areas, difficulty in transportation of construction materials due to road inaccessibility, lack of labors and trained masons, irregularity of Government engineers and people's dependency on Government grant were raised as some of the challenges in the reconstruction.
- Moving forward, the partner organizations should mobilize engineers to increase public awareness on safer construction, to massively conduct masons training and partner organizations not to overlap the similar program for better reconstruction.

Yatra Sharma, Project Coordinator, Lumanti [presented](#) the progress on reconstruction activities with focus on the processes and approaches to building resilient houses and communities.

- In regards to the reconstruction, Lumanti completed construction of 461 houses in four districts (Lalitpur, Kathmandu, Makwanpur and Rasuwa).
- Presentation highlighted how the community mapping for land and housing data and vulnerability mapping were carried out in the project districts, formation of user committees, mobilization of different communities, mobilization of masons, supporting the mason trainings and orientations.
- The focus was also on the involvement of women group and youth volunteer involvement such that user committees become leaders themselves in reconstruction process.
- Further, the experiences of the social mobilizers working closely with different communities were shared.

Ramesh Guragain, Baliyo Ghar, NSET a USAID funded project [presented](#) the overview of its program activities, objective of Baliyo Ghar project along with progress updates on reconstruction.

- The Baliyo Ghar project covers 33 VDCs and 4 municipalities in four districts (Dhading, Dolakha, Kathmandu, Nuwakot), working at three levels: (1) Central: formulating guidelines and strategies, (2) District: Providing training and supporting district team and (3) Local: Technical support and awareness raising.
- Baliyo Ghar in short term aims at ensuring earthquake safer construction and in long term focuses on disaster-resilient construction. The presentation also highlighted the importance of social mobilization in reconstruction.
- The social issues account 80% while the technical issues account 20% in safer building construction, thus social mobilization is critical in reconstruction to build back safer.
- Overall, Baliyo Ghar has trained 4,508 masons from 147 trainings, 1,119 technical personnel trained from 37 trainings, 194 social mobilizers trained and more than 50,000 people oriented directly.
- Baliyo Ghar aims to train 6400 masons by February 2018.

Mr, Birendra Kandel, Engineer MOFALD – CLPU highlighted that there has been a huge gap in the distribution of first, second and third tranche.

- The Households that have received the second and third tranches are very low compared to those that received first tranche.
 - 1st tranche: 5,63,158 HHs
 - 2nd tranche: 33,376 HHs
 - 3rd tranche: 1,814 HHs
- This gap was attributed to communication gap and the working modality. He added that many houses were constructed before the housing guidelines came out which made the houses non-compliance and resulted in huge gap.
- He also said that many of the households were not sure or convinced of getting the government's second and third tranche even if they completed their houses.
- He also reiterated that social mobilization is crucial in reconstruction since social issues account 80% in comparison to the technical issues 20%). Thus, dissemination of accurate and timely information to the communities by the social mobilizers is essential.
- He further said that reconstruction process should be led by the communities not by the social mobilizers and the newly elected local bodies representatives should be involved in the reconstruction.

Questions and Discussion

Q. How to build trust with the communities? Especially during monsoon, election, planting or harvesting seasons how to communicate with the communities of reconstruction?

Lumanti supports and engage different user groups and communities in the reconstruction. Women cooperatives are always in the forefront while Lumanti at the backend formulating guidelines and strategies. This has helped to develop relation between the women's group, communities and Lumanti to work effectively.

Q. What is the difference in rate of construction in VDCs with technical assistance and without it?

There is no significant difference in construction but there is a difference in the compliance of the houses with and without technical assistance.

Q. Are new federal structure maps available?

Yes, NRA MIS has developed the maps for new federal structures. These maps are available from MIS section.

The Joint Secretary, closed the session emphasizing on the social mobilization part and thanked all the presenters and the participants for an interactive session.

Next Steps

HRRPP will coordinate and communicate the schedule for the next technical session

Contact Details

Contact details for the presenters are provided below to facilitate follow up on any of the topics covered in the session.

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